



YOU ARE **21 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

128 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

There is still plenty of room for your baby to move around. Your baby is able to perform complete somersaults and change position several times a day or even several times in a few minutes.

“Bellies come in all shapes and sizes and your doctor will keep track of how your baby is growing.”

If, like some pregnant women, you are feeling big for this halfway stage, it doesn't necessarily mean that you'll have a big baby. And remember, what you think of as too big can be very different from what your doctor is evaluating.

Being large doesn't mean that all your weight is in your belly and from your baby; you may have put on weight on the rest of your body that doesn't affect your baby's size. Women who are carrying twins or triplets do, of course, show earlier and have much larger bellies than those expecting one baby.

The size of your belly is, however, a good indicator of your baby's growth, so it will be measured by your doctor (see [Assessing fetal growth and well-being](#)). They will measure from a point on your pubic bone in your pelvis to the top, or fundus, of the uterus. This measurement should correlate with the number of weeks you're pregnant, with an accuracy of within $\frac{3}{4}$ in (2 cm). So if you're 28 weeks' pregnant, your belly should measure $10\frac{1}{4}$ – $11\frac{3}{4}$ in (26–30 cm). This symphysis fundal height (SFH) will be written in your notes and may be plotted on a growth chart.

If your bump is significantly larger or smaller than it should be for your dates, you're likely to be referred for an ultrasound scan for a more accurate measurement.

ASK A NUTRITIONIST

I've been told to rest, but will I gain too much weight? It's important to follow the advice you've been given, even though it can feel frustrating. Find out if you can go for gentle walks or a swim, since these activities will help you keep fit and relieve stress.

Remember resting is for a short time and for a good purpose—having a healthy baby at full-term. If you aren't active, you are likely to gain weight, but you may find that being less active decreases your appetite. Don't be tempted to cut down on food or miss meals, though. Regular meals and snacks are important to continue to nourish yourself and your baby.

Continue to eat a nutritious, healthy diet, including plenty of fresh fruits and vegetables, complex carbohydrates, and lean protein, and take any supplements such as vitamin D.